

NICK RIOS

ENGINEERING LEADER

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Engineering leader with 20 years experience, **leading teams** and **driving innovation** across products that reached hundreds of millions of page views. I was delivering high-quality enterprise solutions for years before AI existed.

- **2001–2005 · Telecom → Software**
Started in telecom operations at AT&T and Sprint, then transitioned to full-stack software development
- **2005–2012 · Media & Web Platforms**
Shipped websites for 60+ TV stations, a national newspaper network, and B2B clients under real deadlines
- **2012–2020 · Cisco — Enterprise Scale**
Scaled Elasticsearch and Neo4j to enterprise volume, and grew from engineer into trusted team leadership
- **2020–2025 · Digital Harbor — Leadership & AI Innovation**
Led three teams through the company's entire AI adoption, building and shipping a 100+ tool AI platform
- **AI Integration**
Runs local LLMs, voice, video, images, automation, and code. TypeScript, Python, Claude, OpenAI, Gemini, LangChain, n8n

EXPERIENCE

Digital Harbor — Team Lead / Solution Architect

2020 – 2025

This was a brainstorming innovation intense project building next-generation social forms and data capture flows, centered on a multi-tenant full-featured WYSIWYG editor with custom components, beautiful themes, and robust templates.

- Led three teams — 10 engineers total — running daily standups, mentoring, and reviewing code across the org
- Sat with product and execs to shape strategy, pushing the company's innovation agenda across engineering
- Built an AI agent platform with natural-language interfaces that teams used to stand up 100+ LLM-powered agents
- Created a shared Angular/TypeScript component library the whole company adopted, speeding up delivery for every team
- Designed and shipped REST APIs for image and media services, tying together Google, Shutterstock, and other vendors
- Integrated AI code review agents into GitLab CI/CD pipelines, triggered automatically on every push to production

Cisco Systems — Senior Engineer, Team Lead / Solution Architect

2012 – 2020

Built a single pane of glass that gave Cisco's data-center operators a live, unified view of health and alerts across the fleet. The role was an early leadership seat, coordinating engineers, design, ops, and PM. If DH taught me forms, Cisco taught me dashboards.

- Earned repeat promotions leading 8+ engineers through mentorship, hiring input, and consistent delivery execution
- Won a company-wide innovation award and demoed the product live to a global audience of 4,000+ viewers, including SVPs
- Pulled together many scattered microservice data sources into a single, trustworthy source of truth for the org
- Rolled out a graph database at a scale that brought Neo4j's founders to Austin to see the deployment firsthand
- Built predictive alarms that flagged real problems early and cut noisy false alerts for on-call operators
- Connected legacy ticketing systems to a new set of REST APIs that reporting teams rolled out to the public

Nexstar Broadcasting — Software Engineer

2005 – 2009

- Migrated more than 60 television station websites onto one shared platform, launched successfully nationwide
- Helped that shared platform scale to reliably serve more than a million visitors across the network in a single day
- Integrated the shared CMS with legacy newsroom, media, and third-party publishing systems used across the network

Impremedia — Software Engineer

2009 – 2012

- Built a centralized DAM pipeline for 10+ newspapers and magazine publishing systems across the whole organization
- Built PHP/Smarty applications backed by MySQL and SQL, working directly with the CTO and lead solution architect
- Delivered supporting features, including classified ads, as readership shifted steadily from print to digital